

Unit 3 – Section 6: Managing Change & Contingency Planning

One-Page Student Summary Sheet

Key Concepts and Definitions

Concept	Definition	Real-World Example
Business Change	A process where a business alters its operations, structure, or strategy to adapt to internal or external influences.	Tesco adapting its business model for online grocery delivery.
Incremental Change	Small, gradual adjustments over time to improve processes or efficiency.	Toyota implementing lean production improvements.
Disruptive Change	Major transformation caused by new technology or innovation that alters markets.	Netflix revolutionising media consumption through streaming.
Resistance to Change	Opposition by individuals or groups to organisational changes that alter the status quo.	Employees at Twitter opposing cultural and operational shifts.
Kotter & Schlesinger Model	Identifies six methods to overcome resistance: education, participation, facilitation, negotiation, manipulation, and coercion.	Used by IBM to support workforce transitions.
Organisational Culture	The shared values, beliefs, and behaviours that influence how employees act.	Google encouraging innovation through open communication.
Contingency Planning	Preparation of plans to deal with potential future emergencies or disruptions.	Emirates developing crisis management plans for flight disruptions.
Scenario Planning	Considering multiple possible	Shell forecasting oil market

	future events and their potential impact on the business.	scenarios for future investment decisions.
Risk Mitigation	Actions taken to reduce the likelihood or impact of identified business risks.	Apple diversifying suppliers to reduce dependency on one region.

Command Words & AO Focus

Mark	Command Words	AO Skills	Tips for Students
4 marks	Define / Explain	AO1 + AO2	Use precise definitions and short applied examples.
8 marks	Assess	AO2 + AO3	Include two balanced arguments with contextual support.
12 marks	Discuss	AO3 + AO4	Analyse both sides and make a supported mini-judgement.
20 marks	Evaluate	AO1–4 (all)	Balance pros and cons, include stakeholder and time-frame analysis.

High-Frequency Question Themes

- Causes of organisational change (internal vs external).
- Managing resistance using Kotter & Schlesinger's six strategies.
- Evaluating leadership's role in implementing change.
- Importance of contingency and scenario planning for risk management.
- Assessing whether resistance can ever be beneficial to innovation.

Revision Checklist

- ✓ Can I explain internal and external causes of change?
- ✓ Can I describe Kotter & Schlesinger's six methods to overcome resistance?
- ✓ Can I analyse the benefits and limitations of contingency planning?

✓ Can I apply real business examples to support evaluation?

✓ Can I write a balanced 12–20 mark answer using AO1–AO4 effectively?